

80.4 APOSTROPHES AND PLURAL NOUNS

To show belonging with a plural noun that ends in “-s,” just an apostrophe with no “s” is added.

Ginger is my **parents’** cat.

Plural nouns that end with “-s” use an apostrophe with no extra “s.”



To show belonging with a plural noun that doesn't end in “-s,” an apostrophe and an “s” are added.

Polly is our **children’s** parrot.

This is formed in the same way as singular nouns, with an apostrophe and “s.”



FURTHER EXAMPLES

My **friends’** dog is called Rex.



I’m looking after my **cousins’** rabbit.



That is his **grandparents’** house.



She cares about her **students’** grades.



These are the **men’s** rooms.



It depends on the **people’s** vote.



It is important not to confuse “its” with “it’s.” “Its” is a third person singular possessive determiner, and never has an apostrophe. “It’s” is only ever a contraction of “it is.”



The dog is playing with **its** ball. ✓

It’s a shiny, red ball. ✓

This is a possessive so needs no apostrophe.

The dog is playing with **it’s** ball. ✗

Its a shiny, red ball. ✗

This is a contraction of “it is,” so should have an apostrophe before the “s.”